What Are the Elements of A Successful Grant Application?

- Notice of Funding Opportunity or Call for Proposals
- Read it Carefully
- Identify Key Words

What Are the Elements of A Successful Grant Application?

- Must demonstrate:

1. An **important** scientific **problem (significance)**
2. **A compelling research question**
3. **Innovation**-new ideas, methods, products
4. Uses a **rigorous methodology**
5. A **capable research team**
6. **Suitable** research **environment**

Key Components of An NIH R01 Application

Component	Key elements	Typical length
1. Project Title	Clear, concise description of the research	Brief
2. Project Summary	Research problem, objectives, methods, expected outcomes, and impact	30 lines
3. Project Narrative	Relevance of the research to public health	3 sentences
4. Specific Aims	**Overall goal, hypothesis, research aims, and anticipated impact**	**1 page**
5. Research Strategy	Significance, Innovation, and Approach	12 pages
6. References Cited	Scientific literature supporting the proposal	High-impact and critical
7. Investigators' Biosketches	Qualifications, expertise, roles, and relevant contributions	5 pages

Key components of an NIH R01 application Cont..

Component	Key elements	Typical length
8. Budget and Justification	Personnel, equipment, supplies, travel, and other research costs	Based on budget requirements
9. Facilities and Resources	Institutional capabilities, infrastructure, and research environment	As needed
10. Supporting Documents	Letters of support, data management and sharing, human subjects protections, and other applicable plans	Varies

Seven Elements of The Specific Aims

- It is the **most influential page of your application** because it communicates the entire project's scientific rationale and direction

1. **Problem statement**: What major scientific or public health challenge needs to be addressed?

2. **Knowledge gap**: What remains unknown?

3. **Long-term goal**: What broader scientific or health outcome is the research working toward?

4. **Overall objective**: What will this particular project accomplish?

Seven Elements of The Specific Aims Cont…

5. **Central hypothesis or research premise:** What central proposition will guide the research?

6. **Specific aims:** Usually 2–3 focused, achievable, and logically connected aims

7. **Expected outcomes and impact:** What will change in the field if the research succeeds?